

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 7
♥ K Q 6 5 3
♦ 10
♣ A 6 4

♠ A K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ Q 5 2



♠ 10 8 3

♥ 10 2

♦ Q J 8 6 4 2

♣ 8 3

♠ 6 5 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 10 9 7

West	North	East	South
1♥	Dbl	Pass	2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

Ahh, what a difference. Now declarer cannot use the ♥s to enter dummy and he will never get to enjoy those two ♣ winners.

[showcards W:HT N:HJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥10, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥6.

Declarer gets two ♥ winners whether you play one of your honors on this trick or not. So why does it matter what you do?

Suppose you cover with your ♥Q. North will win his ♥A, then play ♣s until your ♣A is forced out on the third round. He can then force an entry to dummy in the ♥ suit to reach the two ♣ winners.

Now suppose you duck the ♥J. Again North will push ♣s, and again you hold up until the third round.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 5 4 2

♥ K Q

♦ A 5

♣ K J 10 8 5

♠ K 10 9 8 6

♥ 8 7 4

♦ Q 7 4

♣ A Q



♠ A J 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 10 9 2

♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q

♥ 10 9 6 5 2

♦ J 8 6 3

♣ 6 4 2

West

1♣

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

contract could no longer be beaten.

North

1♠

East

2NT

South

Pass

[showcards W:SQ N:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠Q, a low card was played from dummy,

Play the ♠K.

It seems that perhaps you should play low and let partner's ♠Q force out East's ♠A. Then, when you get the lead with a high ♣ you can force out East's ♠J. Get the lead with your other high ♣ and set the contract with ♠s.

Suppose you try that. Play low on the first ♠. East will also play low and South will be left holding the trick, and also holding the bag! With no more ♠s South will have to play one of the other three suits, and that is just what East wants to have happen. The

Now do it the right way. Play your ♠K on partner's ♠Q. Assume East takes the trick, although it doesn't matter whether he wins the first one or holds up. When you win your first ♣ drive out East's ♠J. When you win your second ♣ trick your ♠s will be good. If you overtake the first trick the contract can no longer be made.

Notice that East will always make two ♠ tricks, so your overtake costs nothing.